

About me

My name is Quinten Kocian and I am from San Antonio, TX. I attended Judson High School where I played football and baseball.

My first undergraduate degree was awarded in 2016 in International Business (with a minor in Computer Science) from the University of the Incarnate Word (UIW).

I also played NCAA DI football at UIW. I played tight-end, offensive tackle, and defensive end at different times as a football athlete at UIW. Fun fact: when I was an offensive tackle I weighed up to 300 lbs.

As a student at UIW I also worked as an HVAC technician on-campus, servicing commercial equipment such as chillers, boilers, and air handlers.

After graduating with my business degree, I designed commercial HVAC control systems for about 2 years in San Antonio and tech-led a small team of engineers.

In 2018, I returned to school full-time to pursue my second undergraduate degree in Electrical Engineering at the University of Texas at San Antonio (UTSA), with a focus in Digital Signal Processing. I also took several Graduate-level Quantum Computing courses as electives, which is an area that I am passionate about.

While I completed my EE degree, I worked for 2 years at Southwest Research Institute, where I served as an embedded systems and signal processing engineer, leading or contributing to projects involving firmware development, hardware/software integration, acoustic and audio system design, real-time DSP implementation, and technical research.

My biggest accomplishment from my EE degree was leading the Electrical team for a sponsored Senior Design project that led to us winning the entire Technology Symposium and a cash prize.

After completing my EE degree at UTSA, I decided to move up to Austin and Join National Instruments as a Product Manager, where I led the release of a flagship product line of performance power instruments, targeting high-power DC-DC power converters. These products were positioned to capture market share during the current AI boom. I also managed NI's entire high-speed digital and high-speed serial portfolio, mainly serving Semiconductor Production Test.

In my free time I enjoy staying physically active – running, cycling, and lifting. I also really enjoy trying different kinds of craft coffee, wine, and staying plugged into the latest technological developments.

What are you working on now?

Currently, I am taking a brief hiatus from my corporate career as a Senior Product Manager at National Instruments to focus on AI upskilling. I am currently enrolled in the UT Post-Graduate Program in AI for Business Applications. I am also working on the "Proficient AI Engineer" achievement awarded upon completing the Ed Donner AI Curriculum including LLM Engineering, Agentic Engineering, MLOps, and more!

What is your biggest accomplishment?

My biggest accomplishment is leading 4 new product releases in the first 2 years as a Product Manager, resulting in a QoQ ramp rate of 50% and generating 15% lift to my portfolio's overall run-rate. These releases were challenging, requiring coordination across R&D, Sales, Marketing, Web Experience, Sales & Operations Planning, Manufacturing, and Systems. Additionally, I played a technical role in these releases developing key IP, demos, and technical sales enablement.

Name a time when...

- Saved the company a ton of money / defended a revenue stream

Led a cross-functional team resulting in a \$3M bridge-buy recommendation, preserve a \$30M revenue stream tied to a nearly \$200M systems business, balancing cash-outlay and securing the product line. A critical component EOL for a singly-sourced ASIC driven by fab changeover. This fab changeover placed key specifications of the ASIC at risk, and possibly the finished product that I managed. Coordination with S&OP, Procurement, Demand Planning, R&D, and Senior Leadership required.

- Managed a difficult situation

Every day is difficult as a Product Manager! But I would say the most difficult situation was pushing back on a demand from Senior Leadership to build a bloated, expensive product that would have served no target markets well. To do this, I tied the core strategies of my product line to product concepts that were validated with the business units and showed that the product they wanted to build had competing requirements, would be incredibly expensive (and difficult) to build, and that the company was better served releasing targeted products that attacked the broad base and verticals separately.

What sort of roles are you looking for?

I'm a builder: my perfect role allows me to blend my love for technology and PM skills to build the future! I'm enthralled by cutting edge technology and science: AI, space, advanced robotics, and quantum. I believe roles that allow me to flex my technical strengths, business acumen, and passions will be the best fit. Product Management and Venture Capital roles tend to provide a healthy mix of these criteria.

What's your biggest strength?

My biggest strength is my ability to learn complicated, technical topics quickly and apply them to my role. I am a systems thinker and thrive off of understanding how things work together to serve a larger purpose.

What's your biggest weakness?

My biggest weakness is easily the other side of the coin of my biggest strength. I love learning things in detail and at times go a bit too deep, and at times struggling to distill complex topics for a less technical audience. To counter this I have developed a goal-oriented approach to how I work, cutting extraneous detail that does not serve the goal.

Why did you leave your last role or why are you looking for new roles?

I felt like I had outgrown my current position and was starting to stagnate a bit due to various factors at NI. In tandem, my passion for AI was growing and I was looking for a new challenge. As such, I made the decision to focus intensely on AI upskilling and looking for that next career challenge as a Product Manager.

Where do you see yourself in 5 years?

I see myself building the future – AI, space, quantum, advanced robotics. We are currently in an industrial revolution, and as a passionate creator and builder, I want to make an impact!

Are you currently interviewing for other active roles?

Yes, I'm actively interviewing for various roles

Do not include the following:

What are your salary expectations? Hint: what's the role's salary range?

Follow up questions about the company in question

Why is the position open?

(Is it a new position?)

What type of skills is the team missing that you're looking to fill with this new hire?

Who will I work with most closely?

What's your management philosophy?

What's your favorite part of working here?

How has the company changed over the last few years?

What should I read or study up on before I start?

How would you describe the company's culture and values?